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Forest Society And Colonialism,

- 1) Major and Minor forest Products.
- 2) Maintain ecological balance.
- 3) Provide shelter to wild animals i.e. Wildlife.
- 4) Provide employment to the Tribals.
- 5) Soil conservation.
- 6) Maintenance of the seasons and climate.
Forests are shrinking.

- The cutting down of the Forests or their disappearance is called Deforestation.

- As per the India State of Forest Report (ISFR)

2023-24 → India has 7,15,343 sq. km. Forest Area.

⇒ Causes of Deforestation:

1) Agricultural Expansion → To bring more land in

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Agriculture.

- In 1600 $\rightarrow \frac{1}{6th}$ of Total landmass of India was under Agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ Between 1880 - 1920 $\rightarrow$ 7 million Hectare of land is under agriculture.

$\rightarrow$ At present = 153.90 ^{million} Hectares of land Under agriculture. (1 Hectare = 20 kanal).

2) Introduction of New Crop.

- Jute, Indigo, Sugar, Tea, Coffee, Cotton, Tobacco.

3) Sleepers for the Railway Track.

- Forest were cut for making sleepers of the Railway Tracks.



- ★ ⇒ One Mile of Railway needed 1760 - 2000 sleepers.
- 4) Wood or Timber for ship building:-
- Special tree for ship building was Oak Tree.
- 5) Promotion of Tea Plantation:-
- 6) Fuel for the steam Engine. Fire wood as fuel for steam engines.
- 7) Construction of the dams and reservoirs.
- 8) Urbanisation: Emergence of new Towns and cities.
- 9) Mining: i.e. extraction of minerals from the forest land.
- 10) Industrialisation: Emergence of new Industries from the forest land.
- 11) Laying of the ~~roads~~ Roads Through the Forest.

P.T.O



⇒ Rise of Commercial Forestry:-

- 1) The major and minor forest products have now been sold in the market to earn money.
- 2) British govt. managed the Indian Forest on commercial lines i.e. as commercial or Profit Purpose.
- 3) The British Govt. Invited German Scientist Dietrich Brandis.
- 4) He gave his suggestions for the Commercial Forestry.
- 5) He was made as the first Inspector General of the forest. (IG) in India.
- 6) In 1864:- He introduced Indian Forest Service



(IFS). and Indian Forest act in 1865.

7) Dietrich Brandis also set up Indian Forest Research Institute in Dehradun (UP) and at present in Uttarakhand. (IFRI).

⇒ Features/Provisions of the Forest Act of 1865:-
(or its ~~important~~ impact on Tribals).

- 1) Only the dead or Diseased trees to be extracted from the forest.
- 2) New trees be planted in the places of all trees.
- 3) Trees are to be planted in the straight lines, with a particular type of trees in a particular region.
- 4) Forest officials to Inspect forest regularly.



- 5) No grazing of the cattle allowed in the forest.
- 6) This Act did not permit any Tribal to extract any ~~deprived of their right~~ forest product from the forest.
- 7) The tribals were dislocated from the forest and deprived of their right.
- 8) They could not raise cattle as their means of livelihood.

⇒ In 1878:- Forest Amendment act of 1878.
Divided Forest into 3 categories.

- ① Reserved Forests No forest activity were allowed.
- ② Protected Forest → Very minor and permitted forest Activity allowed.
- ③ Village Forest.